Lecture 7: Model Selection and Regularization

STATS 202: Data Mining and Analysis

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Announcements

- HW1 is graded.
  - Regrade requests are allowed up to 1 week from publication
- HW1 is being graded now (contact us if you haven't submitted)
- Midterm is this Wednesday
  - Accommodations should be confirmed
  - No calculators necessary
- Annonymous course survey will be posted on Wednesday
  - Closes Tuesday afternoon
  - Up to 10 additional bonus points on exam (conditional on % participation)
- No section this Friday

- Subset selection
- Shrinkage methods
  - Ridge
  - LASSO
  - Elastic net

What we know so far

- In linear regression, adding predictors always decreases the training error or RSS.

$$RSS = (\mathbf{Y} - \mathbf{X}\beta)^\top(\mathbf{Y} - \mathbf{X}\beta) \tag{1}$$

- We can estimate β by minimizing the RSS.

$$\hat{\boldsymbol{\beta}} = (\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X})^{-1}\mathbf{X}^\top y \tag{2}$$

- However, adding predictors does not necessarily improve the test error.
- Selecting significant predictors is hard when n is not much larger than p.

Singular matrices

- When our matrix is not of *full column rank* (e.g. $n < p$), we have that $(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1}$ is not invertible.
- Consequently, there is no least squares solution:

$$\hat{\beta} = \underbrace{(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})}_{\text{Singular}}{}^{-1} \mathbf{X}^\top y \tag{3}$$

  - So, we must find a way around this.

Accounting for singularity

$$\hat{\beta} = \underbrace{(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})}_{\text{Singular}}{}^{-1} \mathbf{X}^\top y \tag{4}$$

Three common approaches for dealing with this:

1. Subset selection
   - Select a subset k of the p predictors ($k \leqslant p$).
   - Use criteria to help select which subset k we want.

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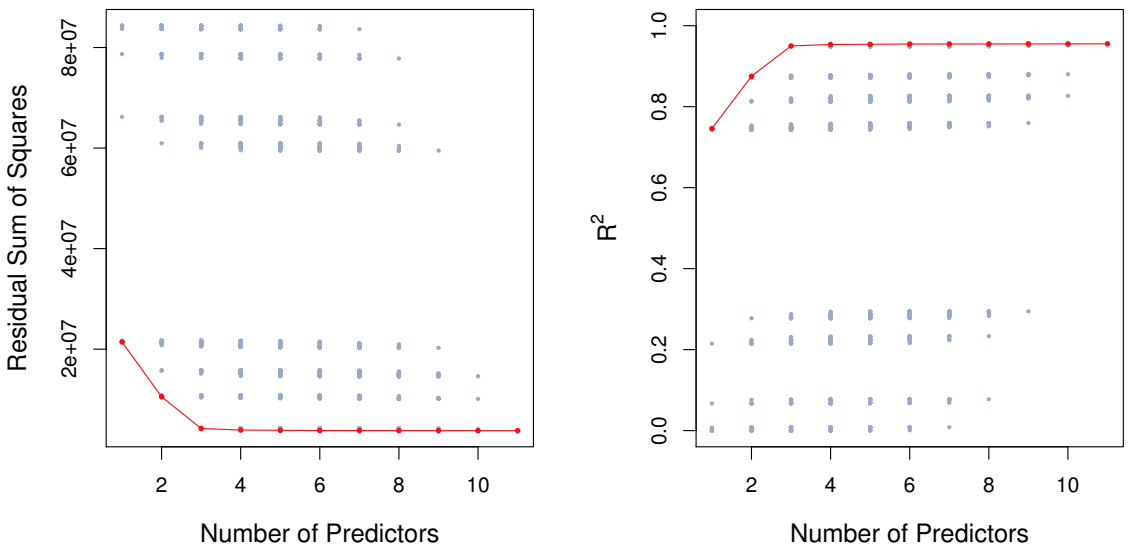
2. Shrinkage methods
   - Constrain the parameters we're estimating in some way
3. Dimension reduction
   - Project all our predictors to a smaller dimension space
   - Not covered in this class

Subset selection

- *Simple idea*: Compare all models with k predictors
- **Note**: There are $\binom{p}{k} = p!/(k!(p-k)!)$ possible models
- Choose the model with the smallest RSS
  - Doing this for every possible k:



Note: As expected, the RSS and R^2 improve with higher k.

The optimal k

Two approaches:

1. Use a hold out set (e.g. validation or test set)
   - c.f. Cross-validation
2. Use *modified* metrics that account for the size of k, e.g.
   - Akaike Information Criterion (AIC)
   - Bayesian Information Criterion (BIC)
   - Adjusted R^2

The optimal k

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How the modified metrics compare to using hold out sets

- Can be (much) less expensive to compute
- Motivated by asymptotic arguments and rely on model assumptions (e.g. normality of the errors)
- Equivalent concepts for other models (e.g. logistic regression)

Akaike Information Criterion (AIC)

Similar to Mallow's C_p:

$$C_p = \frac{1}{n}(RSS + 2k\hat{\sigma}^2) \tag{5}$$

- i.e. Adds the penalty $2k\hat{\sigma}^2$ to the RSS
- Can be shown to be unbiased estimate of test set error

But, also normalizes for $\hat{\sigma}^2$:

$$AIC = \frac{1}{n\hat{\sigma}^2}(RSS + 2k\hat{\sigma}^2) = \frac{C_p}{\hat{\sigma}^2} \tag{6}$$

Since the two are proportional, (for least squares models) both are optimized at the same k.

Bayesian Information Criterion (BIC)

Similar to Mallow's C_p, but derived from Bayesian POV:

$$BIC = \frac{1}{n}(RSS + \log(n)k\hat{\sigma}^2) \tag{7}$$

n.b. $\log(n) > 2$ for $n > 7$

- BIC will penalize more for large k (i.e. optimizes for smaller k)

Adjusted R^2

Recall:

$$R^2 = 1 - \frac{RSS}{TSS} \tag{8}$$

The adjusted R^2 penalizes for larger k:

$$R^2_{adj} = 1 - \frac{RSS/(n-d-1)}{TSS/(n-1)} \tag{9}$$

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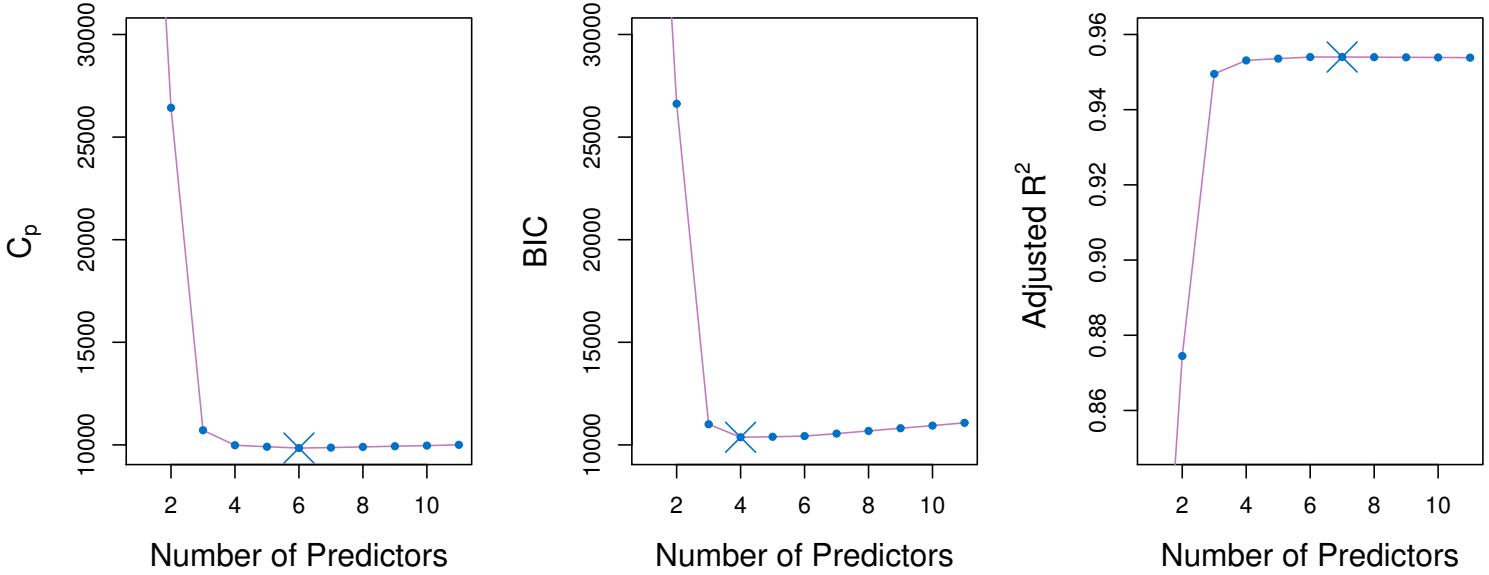
$$R^2_{adj} = 1 - \frac{RSS/(n-d-1)}{TSS/(n-1)} \tag{9}$$

Maximizing R^2_{adj} is equivalent to minimizing $1 - R^2_{adj}$, i.e.:

$$\frac{RSS}{n-d-1} \tag{10}$$

Applied example

Best subset selection for the Credit data set



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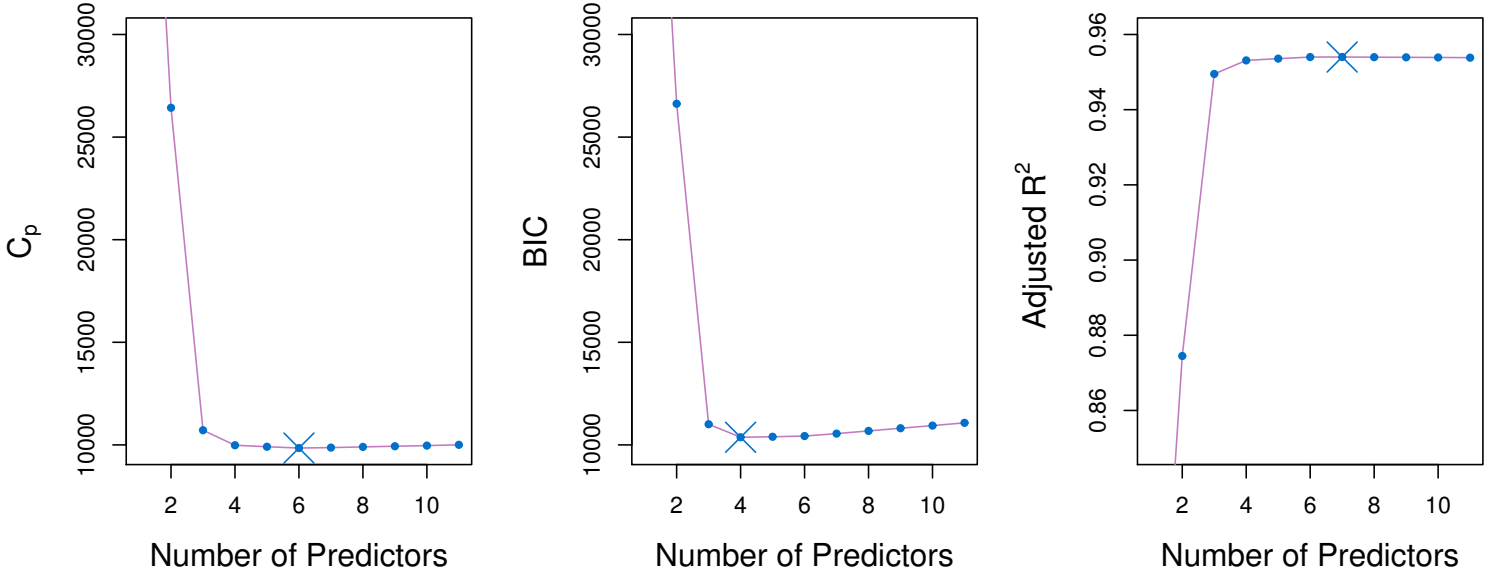
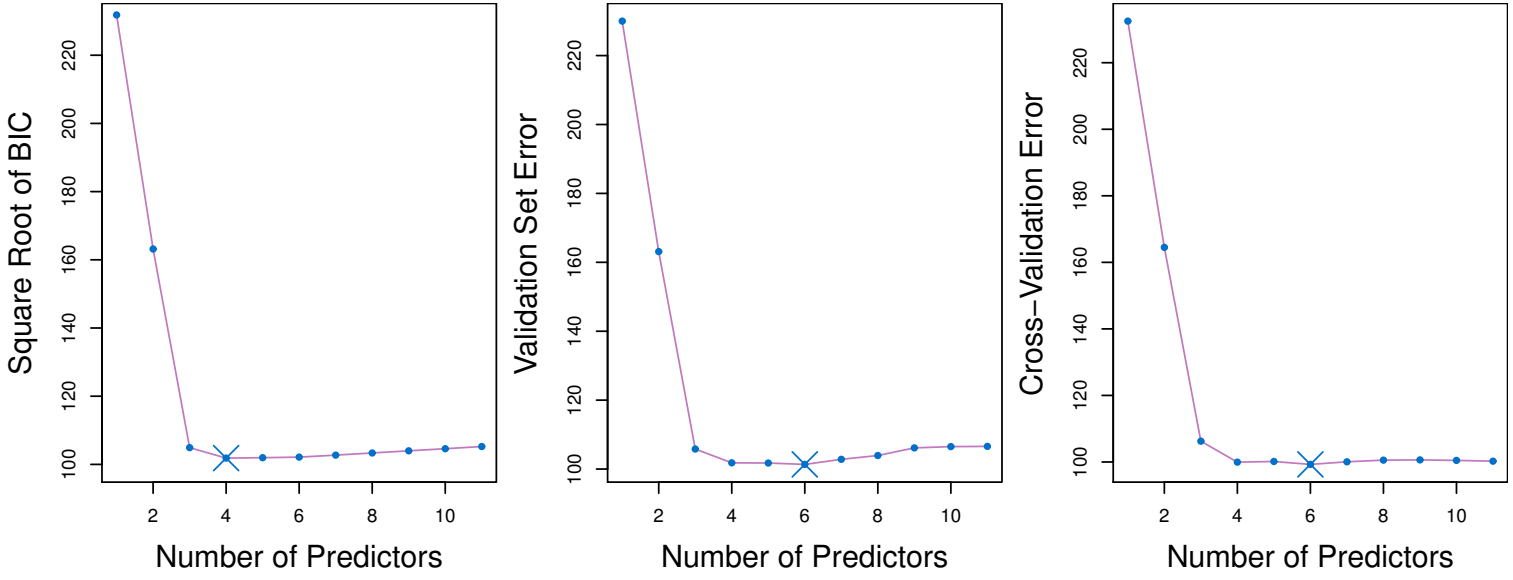
Best subset selection for the Credit data set



n.b. The curve is pretty flat for $k \geq 4$

Applied example

BIC vs validation sets



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Applied example

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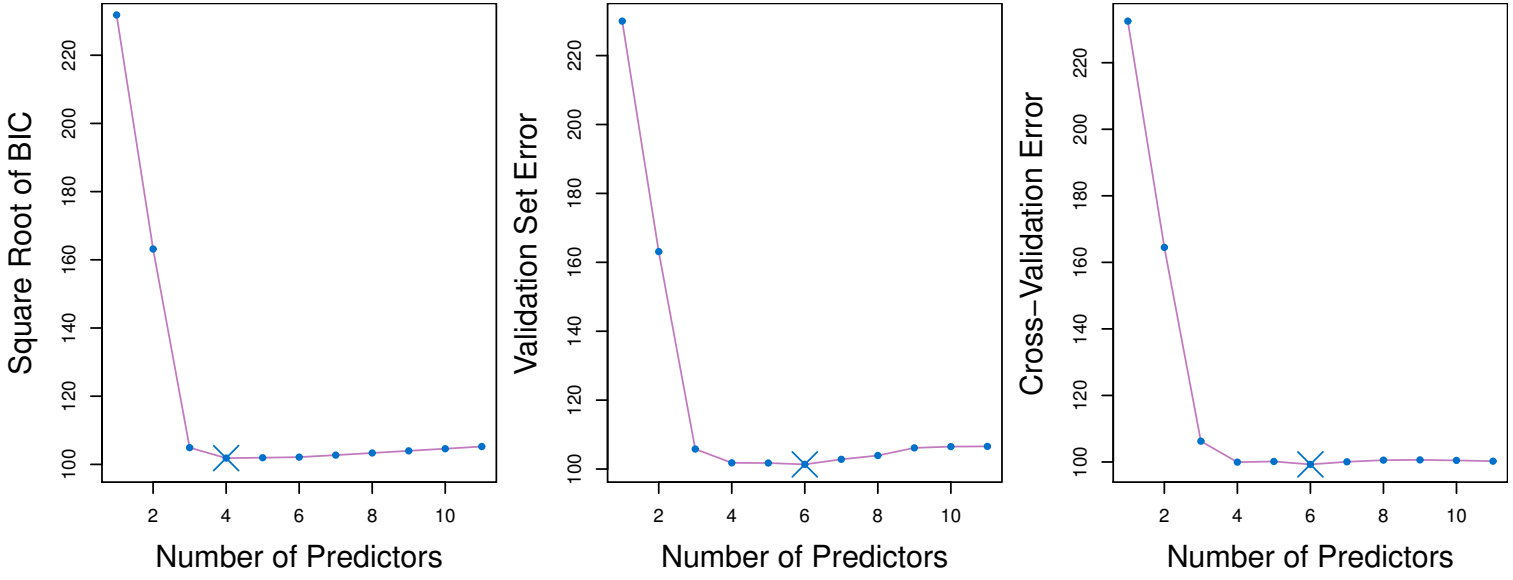

n.b. The curves are also pretty flat for $k \geq 4$.

Can use the *one-standard-error rule*

- Choose the parsimonious model (i.e. lowest k) such that the test error is within 1-SE of the lowest point

Stepwise selection methods

Best subset selection has 2 problems:

1. It is often very expensive computationally. We have to fit 2^p different models!
2. If for a fixed k, there are too many possibilities, we increase our chances of overfitting
   - i.e. the model selected has high variance.

Stepwise selection methods

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One solution: Restrict our search space for the best model

- This reduces the variance of the selected model at the expense of an increase in bias.

Forward stepwise selection

Algorithm 6.2 *Forward stepwise selection*

1. Let $\mathcal{M}_0$ denote the *null* model, which contains no predictors.
2. For $k = 0, \ldots, p-1$:
   (a) Consider all $p-k$ models that augment the predictors in $\mathcal{M}_k$ with one additional predictor.
   (b) Choose the *best* among these $p-k$ models, and call it $\mathcal{M}_{k+1}$. Here *best* is defined as having smallest RSS or highest R^2.
3. Select a single best model from among $\mathcal{M}_0, \ldots, \mathcal{M}_p$ using cross-validated prediction error, C_p (AIC), BIC, or adjusted R^2.

Forward selection vs best subset

# Variables	Best subset	Forward stepwise
One	`rating`	`rating`
Two	`rating`, `income`	`rating`, `income`
Three	`rating`, `income`, `student`	`rating`, `income`, `student`
Four	`cards`, `income` `student`, `limit`	`rating`, `income`, `student`, `limit`

TABLE 6.1. *The first four selected models for best subset selection and forward stepwise selection on the* `Credit` *data set. The first three models are identical but the fourth models differ.*

Backward stepwise selection

Algorithm 6.3 *Backward stepwise selection*

1. Let $\mathcal{M}_p$ denote the *full* model, which contains all p predictors.
2. For $k = p, p-1, \ldots, 1$:
   (a) Consider all k models that contain all but one of the predictors in $\mathcal{M}_k$, for a total of $k-1$ predictors.
   (b) Choose the *best* among these k models, and call it $\mathcal{M}_{k-1}$. Here *best* is defined as having smallest RSS or highest R^2.
3. Select a single best model from among $\mathcal{M}_0, \ldots, \mathcal{M}_p$ using cross-validated prediction error, C_p (AIC), BIC, or adjusted R^2.

Forward vs backward selection

- You cannot apply backward selection when $p > n$
  - Though should still have a "reasonable" number of observations
- **Important**: they may not produce the same sequence of models.
  Example: $X_1, X_2 \overset{iid}{\sim} \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2)$

$$X_3 = X_1 + 3X_2 \tag{11}$$
$$Y = X_1 + 2X_2 + \epsilon \tag{12}$$

Regressing Y onto X_1, X_2, X_3:

- Forward: $\{X_3\} \to \{X_3, X_2\} \to \{X_3, X_2, X_1\}$
- Backward: $\{X_1, X_2, X_3\} \to \{X_1, X_2\} \to \{X_2\}$

Other stepwise selection methods

- *Mixed stepwise selection*: Do forward selection, but at every step, remove any variables that are no longer "necessary"
  - e.g. using p-values
- *Forward stagewise selection*: Do forward selection, but after every step, modify the remaining predictors such that they are uncorrelated to the selected predictors.
- etc.

Issues with stepwise methods

Important things to keep in mind:

- The selected model is not guaranteed to be optimal
  - There are often several equally good models
- The procedure does not take into account a researcher's knowledge about the predictors
- Outliers can have a large impact on the procedure
- Some predictors should be considered together as a group (e.g. dummy indicators for seasons of the year)
- The coefficients, R^2, p-values, CI's, etc are all biased/invalid
- Should not over-interpret the order that the predictors are included
- Cannot conclude that all variables included are important, or all excluded variables are unimportant

Shrinkage methods

Allows us to use all p predictors, but will regularize (i.e. shrink) their coefficients in some way.

- Common to shrink them towards 0

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- Common to shrink them towards 0

Question: Why would shrunk coefficients be better?

- Will introduce bias, but can significantly reduce the variance
  - If the variance is noticeably larger, this decreases the test error
- There are Bayesian motivations to do this: the prior tends to shrink the parameters.

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Three common shrinkage methods:

1. Ridge regression
2. Lasso regression
3. Elastic net

Ridge regression

Ridge regression solves the following optimization:

$$\min_{\beta} \quad \sum_{i=1}^{n} \left(y_i - \beta_0 - \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j x_{i,j} \right)^2 + \lambda \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j^2 \tag{13}$$

In blue: the model RSS
In red: the squared ℓ_2 norm of β, or $\|\beta\|_2^2$

The parameter $\lambda > 0$ is a tuning parameter. It modulates the importance of fit vs. shrinkage.

- Typically determined via e.g. cross-validation

Ridge regression

Writing our loss function in matrix form

$$(\mathbf{Y} - \mathbf{X}\beta)^\top(\mathbf{Y} - \mathbf{X}\beta) + \lambda\beta^\top\beta \tag{14}$$

it can be shown that

$$\hat{\beta}_n^{ridge} = (\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X} + \lambda\mathbf{I_n})^{-1}\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{Y} \tag{15}$$

- So ridge regression simply adds a positive constant to $\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X}$, making it non-singular.

Ridge regression

Under the linear model, the mean and covariance of $\hat{\beta}_n^{ridge}$ are:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}[\hat{\beta}_n^{ridge}|\mathbf{X}] &= (\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X} + \lambda\mathbf{I_n})^{-1}\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{Y}|\mathbf{X}] \\ &= (\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X} + \lambda\mathbf{I_n})^{-1}\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X}\beta\end{aligned} \tag{16}$$

$$\begin{aligned}Cov[\hat{\beta}_n^{ridge}|\mathbf{X}] &= (\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X} + \lambda\mathbf{I_n})^{-1}\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{Cov}[\mathbf{Y}|\mathbf{X}] \\ &\quad X^\top(\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X} + \lambda\mathbf{I_n})^{-1} \\ &= \sigma^2(\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X} + \lambda\mathbf{I_n})^{-1}\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X}(\mathbf{X}^\top\mathbf{X} + \lambda\mathbf{I_n})^{-1}\end{aligned} \tag{17}$$

Scaling predictors

In least-squares regression, scaling the variables has no effect on the fit of the model:

$$Y = X_0 + \beta_1 X_1 + \beta_2 X_2 + \cdots + \beta_p X_p \tag{18}$$

e.g. Multiplying X_1 by c can be compensated by dividing $\hat{\beta}_1$ by c

- i.e. Doing this results in the same RSS

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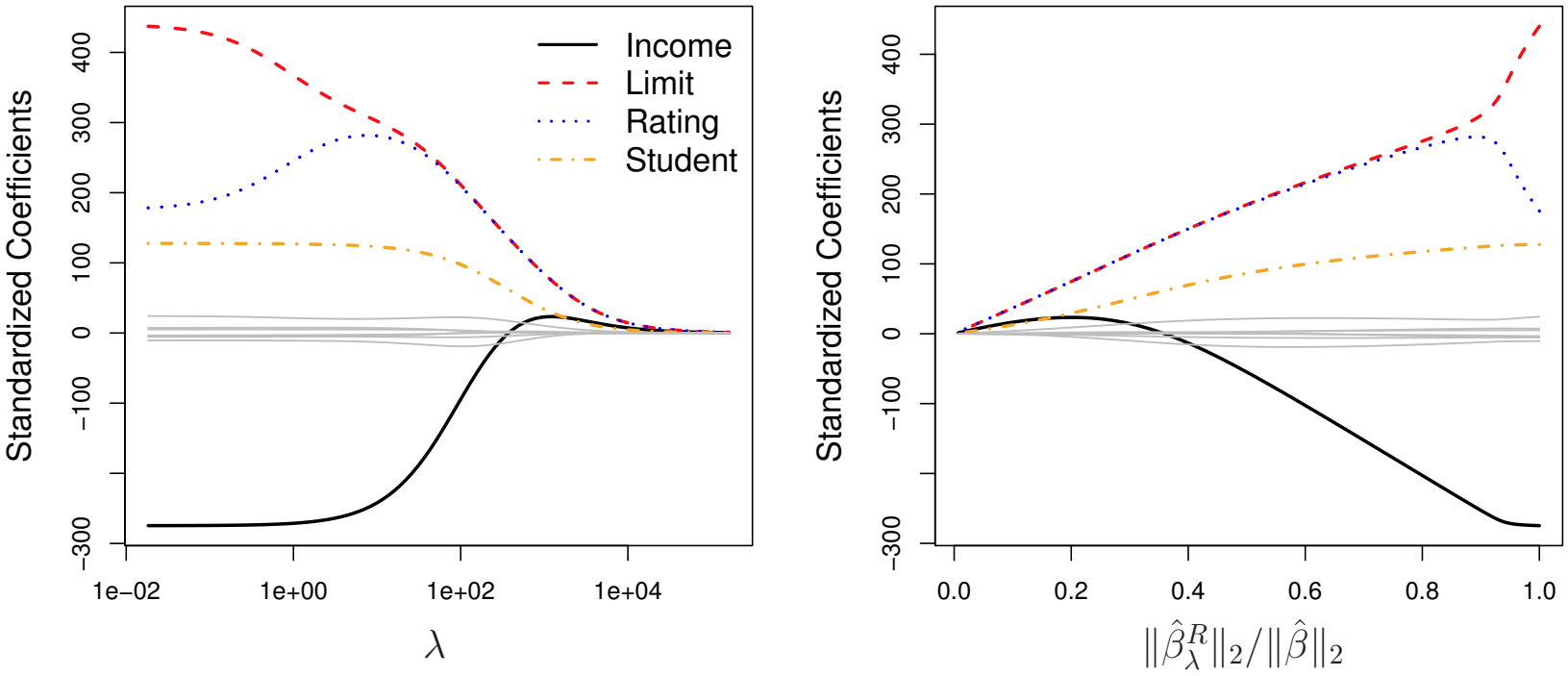
This is not true for ridge regression!

- Due to $\|\beta\|_2^2$
- **In practice**: standardize all predictors (i.e. center and scale such that it has sample variance 1)
  - e.g. *glmnet* (by Hastie, Tibshirani, and Friedman)

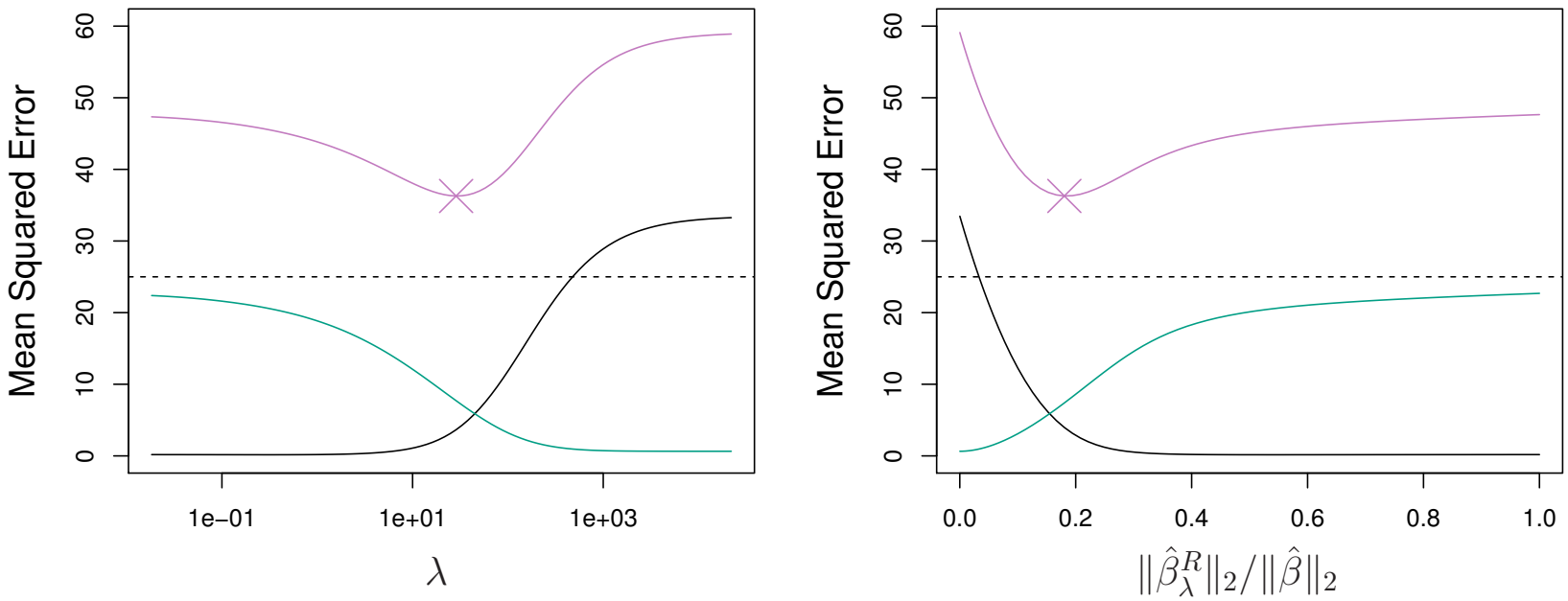
Example: Ridge regression

Ridge regression of `default` in the Credit dataset.



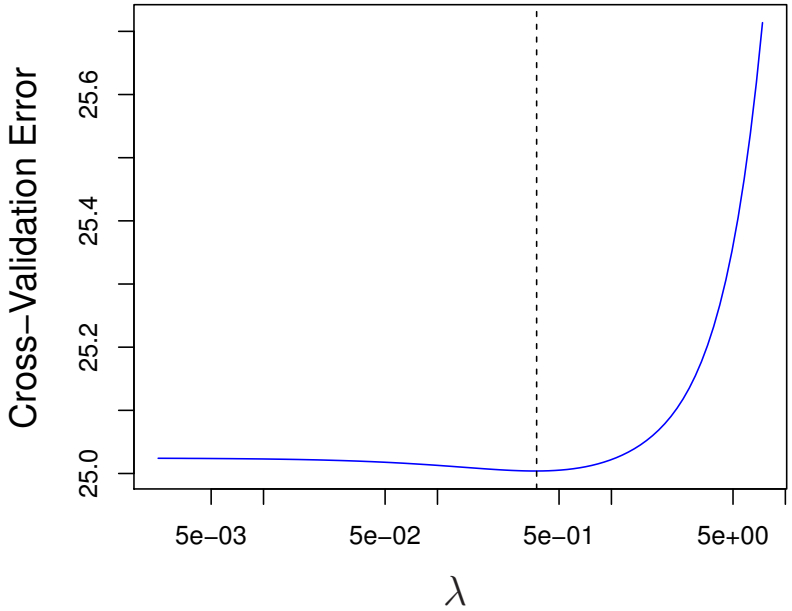
Bias variance trade-off

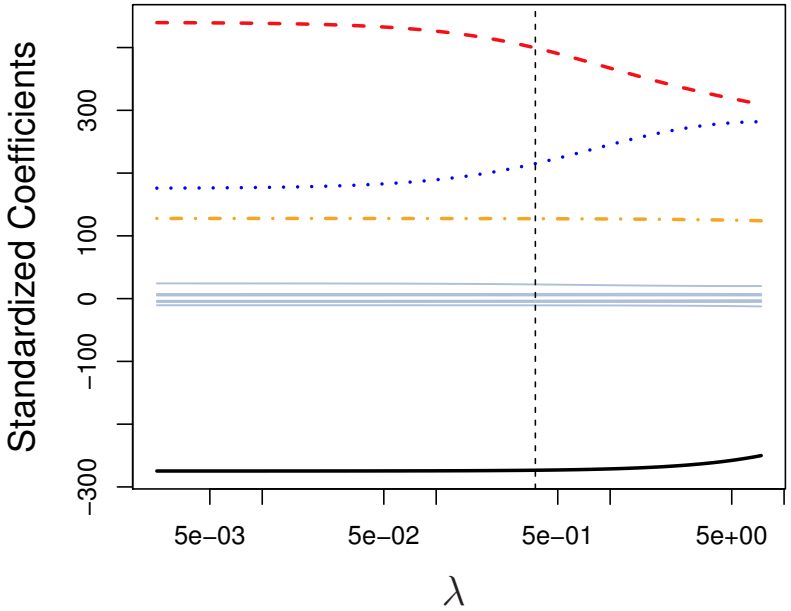
Computing the bias, variance, and test error as a function of λ (in simulation).



Cross validation would yield an estimate of the test error.

Selecting λ by cross-validation





The Lasso

The **L**east **A**bsolute **S**hrinkage and **S**election **O**perator regression solves the following optimization:

$$\min_{\beta} \quad \sum_{i=1}^{n} \left(y_i - \beta_0 - \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j x_{i,j} \right)^2 + \lambda \sum_{j=1}^{p} |\beta_j| \tag{19}$$

In blue: the model RSS

In red: the ℓ_1 norm of β, or $\|\beta\|_1$

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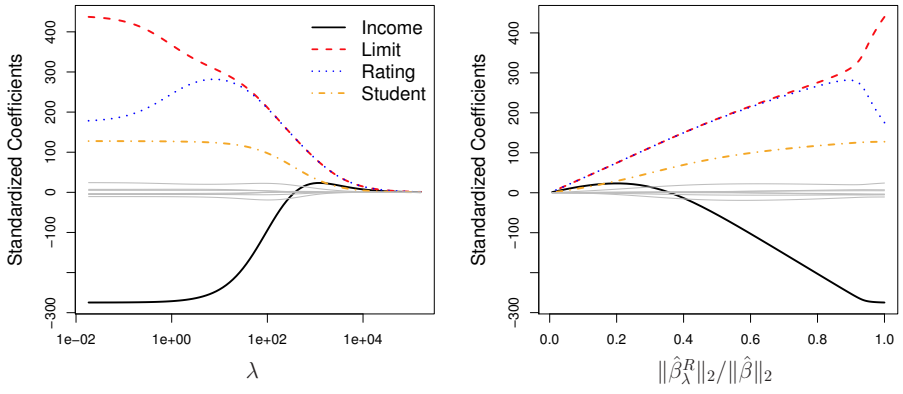
In red: the ℓ_1 norm of β, or $\|\beta\|_1$ **Note**: Unlike ridge regression, LASSO does not have a closed form solution.

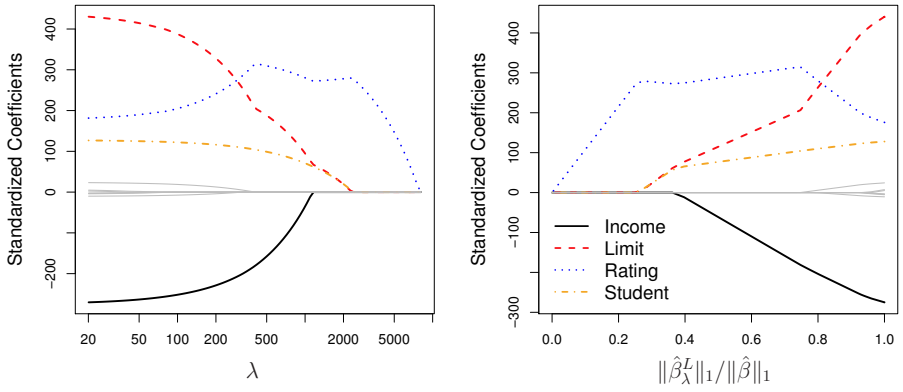
Why would we use the Lasso instead of Ridge regression?

- Ridge regression shrinks all the coefficients to a non-zero value
- The Lasso shrinks some of the coefficients all the way to zero.
  - Similar to subset selection: will select variables for you

Ridge regression of `default` in the Credit dataset.



Lasso regression of `default` in the Credit dataset.



An alternative formulation for regularization

- **Ridge:** for every λ, there is an s such that $\hat{\beta}_\lambda^R$ solves:

$$\min_\beta \left\{ \sum_{i=1}^n \left(y_i - \beta_0 - \sum_{j=1}^p \beta_j x_{i,j} \right)^2 \right\} \text{ subject to } \sum_{j=1}^p \beta_j^2 < s \quad (20)$$

- **Lasso:** for every λ, there is an s such that $\hat{\beta}_\lambda^L$ solves:

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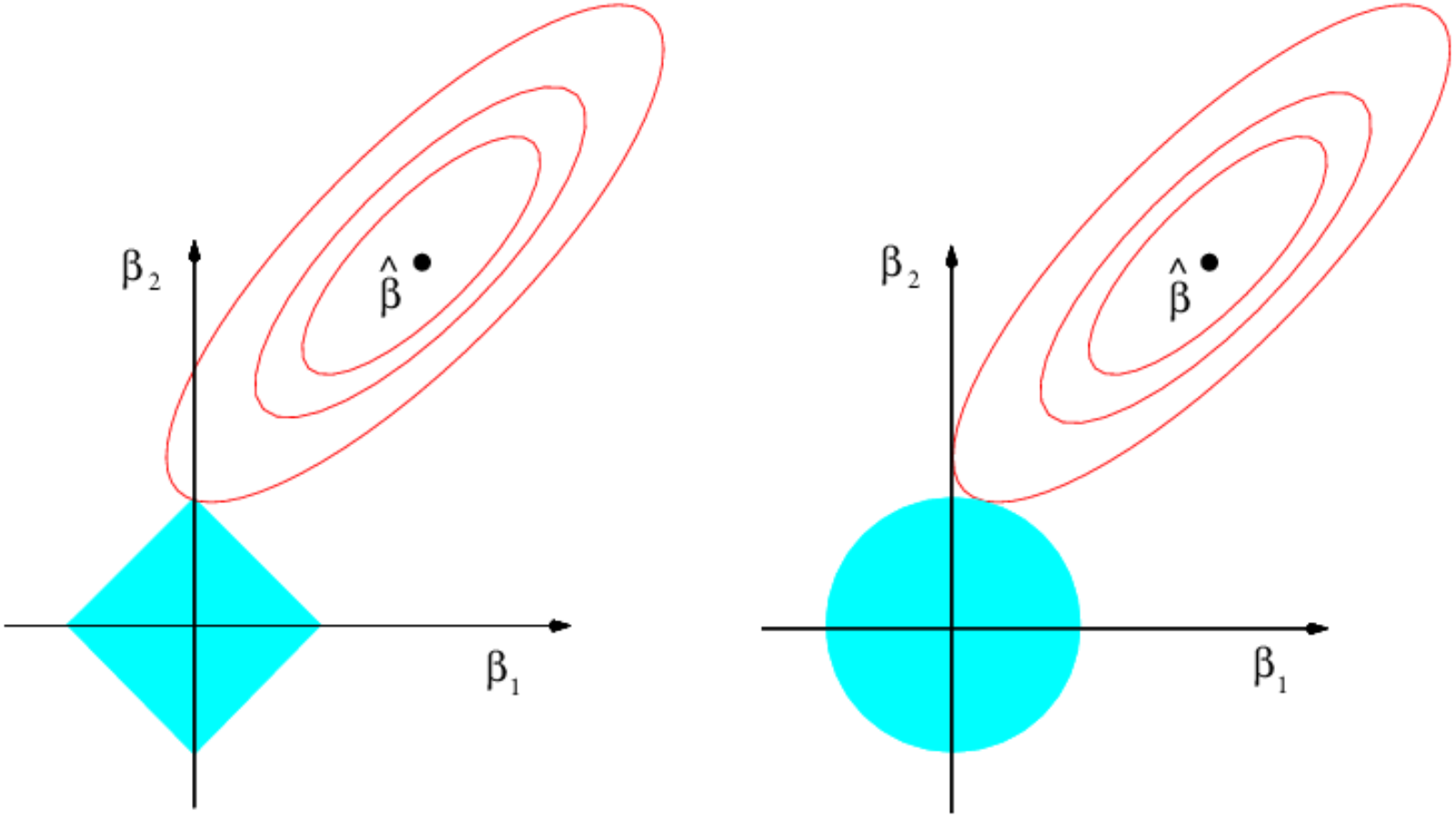
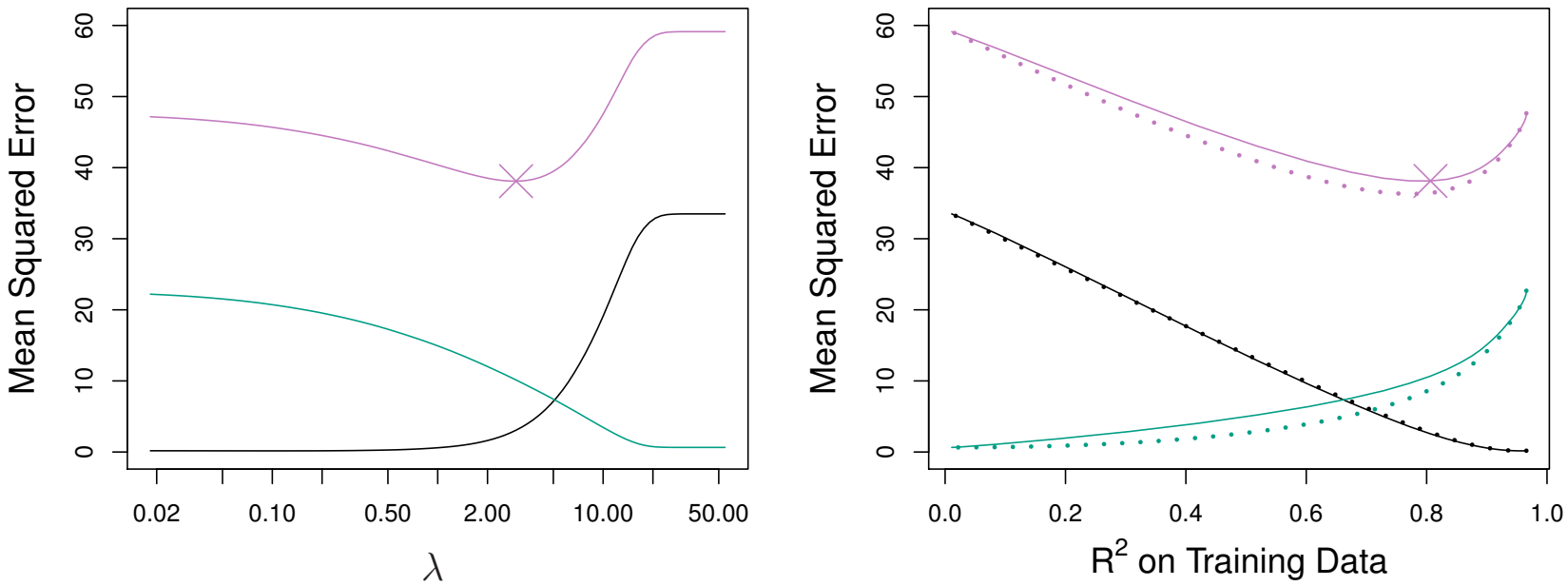


When is the Lasso better than Ridge?

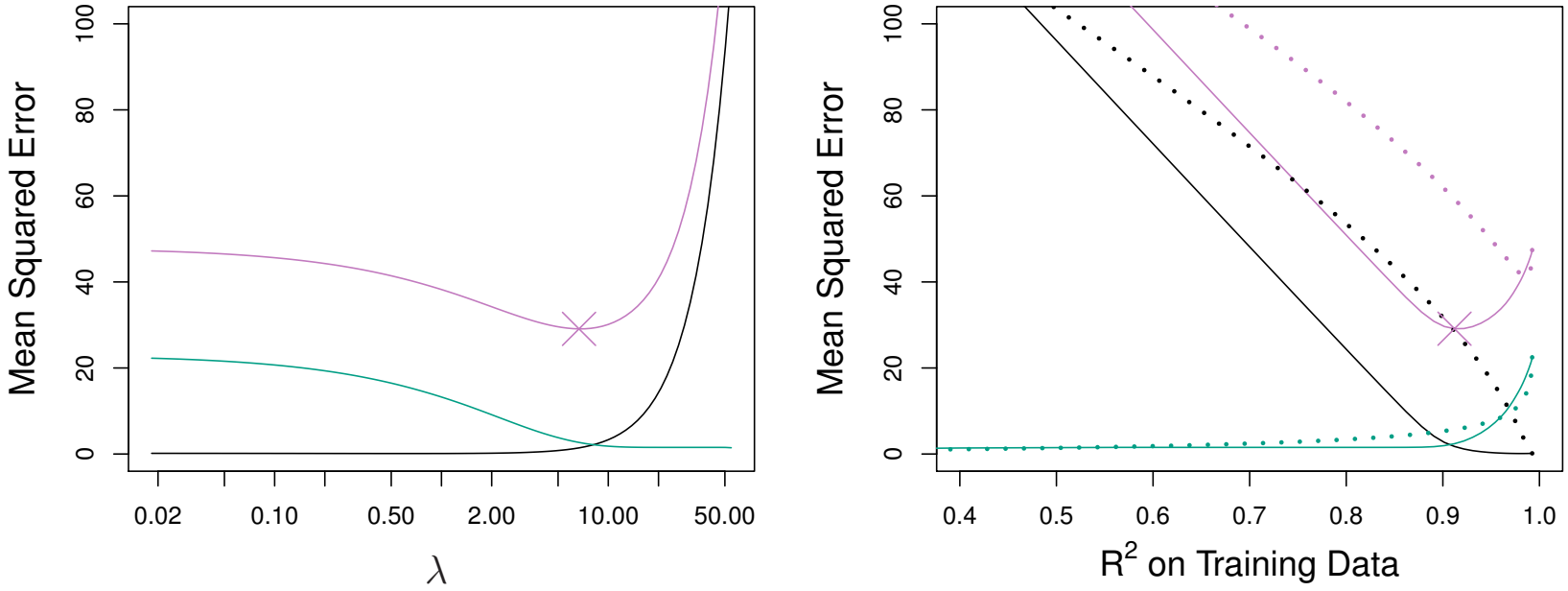
Example 1. Most of the coefficients are non-zero.



- Bias, Variance, MSE. The Lasso (—), Ridge (· · ·).
- The bias is about the same for both methods.
- The variance of Ridge regression is smaller, so is the MSE.

When is the Lasso better than Ridge?

Example 2. Only 2 coefficients are non-zero.



- Bias, Variance, MSE. The Lasso (—), Ridge ($\cdots$).
- The bias, variance, and MSE are lower for the Lasso.

Elastic Net

Combines $\|\beta\|_2^2$ (ridge) and $\|\beta\|_1$ (lasso) penalties.

Elastic net solves the following optimization:

$$\min_{\beta} \quad \sum_{i=1}^{n} \left(y_i - \beta_0 - \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j x_{i,j} \right)^2 + \lambda_2 \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j^2 + \lambda_1 \sum_{j=1}^{p} |\beta_j| \quad (22)$$

In blue: the model RSS
In red: both $\|\beta\|_2^2$ and $\|\beta\|_1$

This provides a nice trade off between sparsity and grouping.

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This provides a nice trade off between sparsity and grouping.

Typically, we define $\alpha = \frac{\lambda_2}{\lambda_2 + \lambda_1}$ and instead optimize:

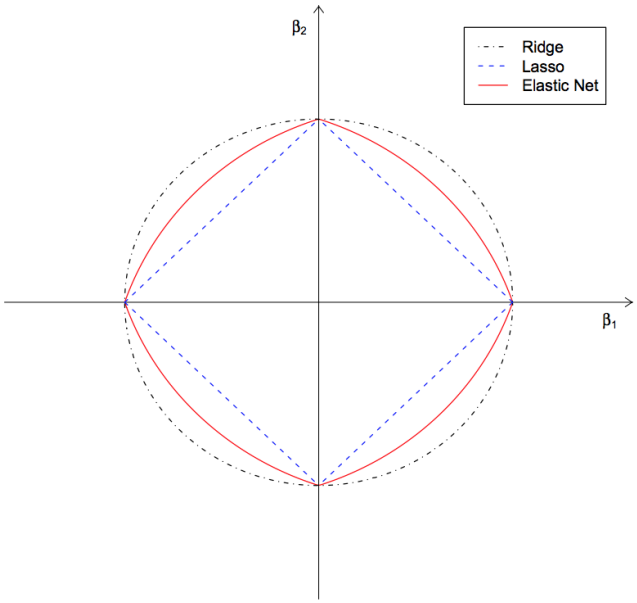
$$\min_{\beta} \quad \sum_{i=1}^{n} \left(y_i - \beta_0 - \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j x_{i,j} \right)^2 + \alpha \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j^2 + (1-\alpha) \sum_{j=1}^{p} |\beta_j| \quad (23)$$

An alternative formulation for regularization

Elastic net:

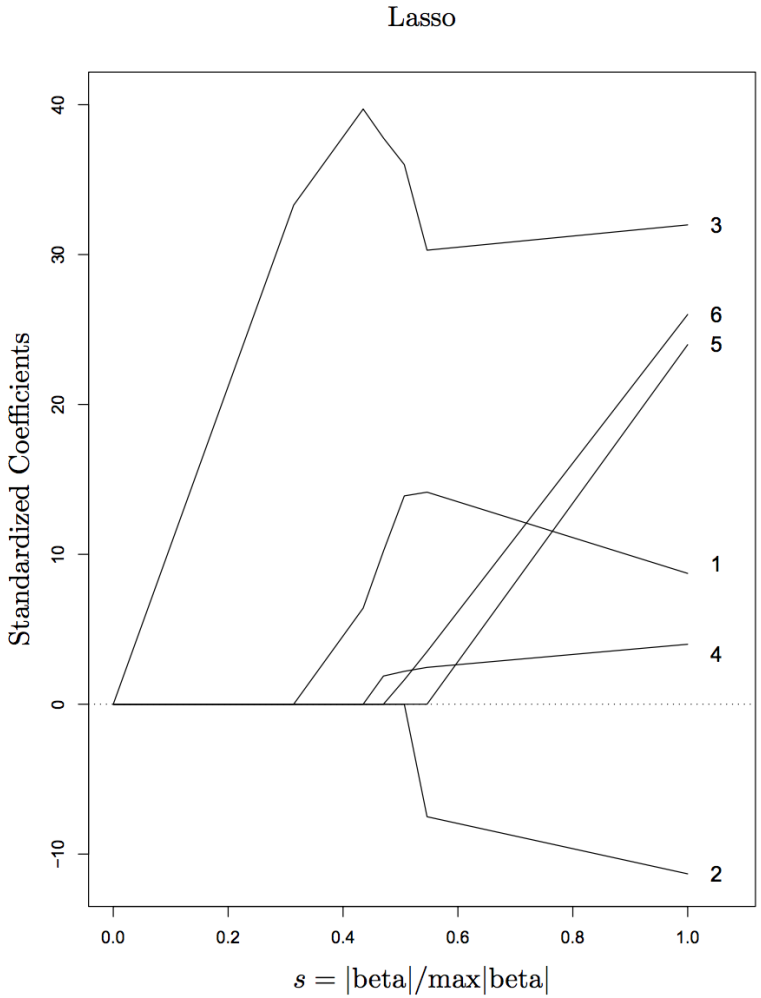
$$\min_{\beta} \left\{ \sum_{i=1}^{n} \left(y_i - \beta_0 - \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j x_{i,j} \right)^2 \right\} \text{ s.t. } \alpha \|\beta\|_2^2 + (1-\alpha)\|\beta\|_1 < s \quad (24)$$

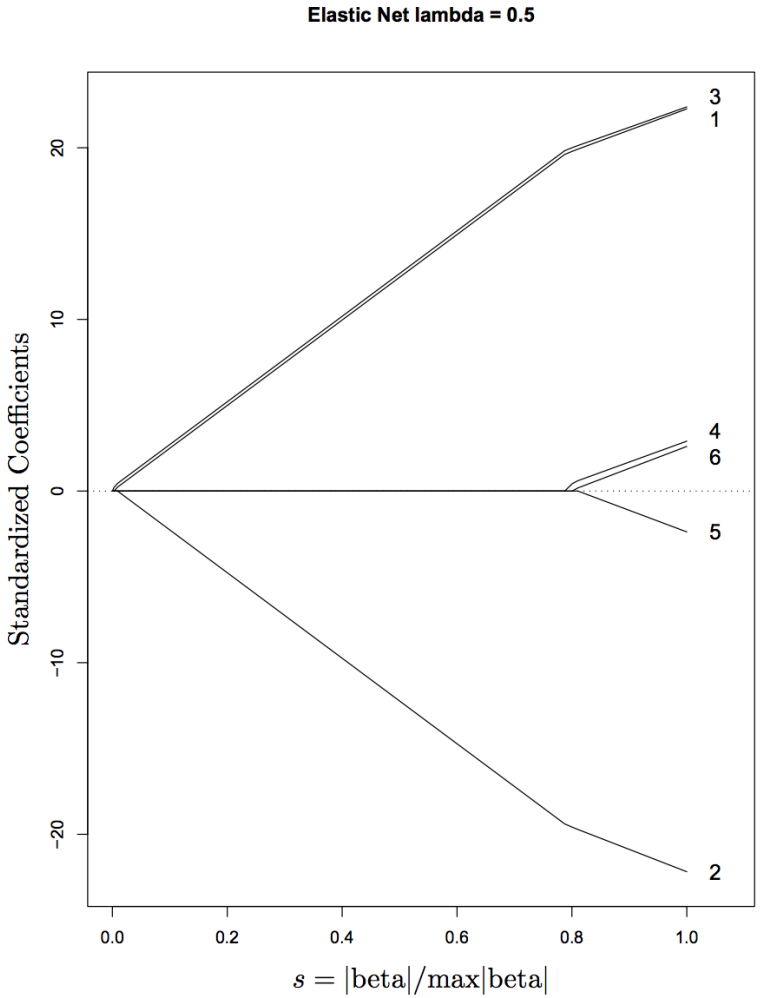
2-dimensional illustration $\alpha = 0.5$



- Singularities at the vertexes (to encourage sparsity)
- Strict convex edges (to encourage grouping)
  - The strength of convexity varies with α

Example: Elastic net





Shrinkage summaries

$$\min_{\beta} \quad \sum_{i=1}^{n} \left(y_i - \beta_0 - \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j x_{i,j} \right)^2 + \lambda_2 \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j^2 + \lambda_1 \sum_{j=1}^{p} |\beta_j| \quad (25)$$

Method	**Shrinkage parameters**
OLS	$\lambda_1 = \lambda_2 = 0$
Ridge	$\lambda_1 = 0, \lambda_2 > 0$
LASSO	$\lambda_1 > 0, \lambda_2 = 0$
Elastic net	$\lambda_1 > 0, \lambda_2 > 0$
$\hat{\beta}_n = 0$	$\lambda_1 = \infty$ or $\lambda_2 = \infty$

A very special case

Suppose $n = p$, such that our predictor matrix is $X_{n \times n}$.
Then, the objective function in ridge regression can be simplified to

$$\sum_{j=1}^{p} (y_j - \beta_j)^2 + \lambda \sum_{j=1}^{p} \beta_j^2 \tag{26}$$

and we can minimize the terms involving each β_j individually:

$$(y_j - \beta_j)^2 + \lambda \beta_j^2 \tag{27}$$

In this scenario, it can be shown that

$$\hat{\beta}_j^{ridge} = \frac{y_j}{1 + \lambda} \tag{28}$$

A very special case

Suppose $n = p$, such that our predictor matrix is $X_{n \times n}$.
We have a similar story for LASSO:

$$\sum_{j=1}^{p} (y_j - \beta_j)^2 + \lambda \sum_{j=1}^{p} |\beta_j| \tag{29}$$

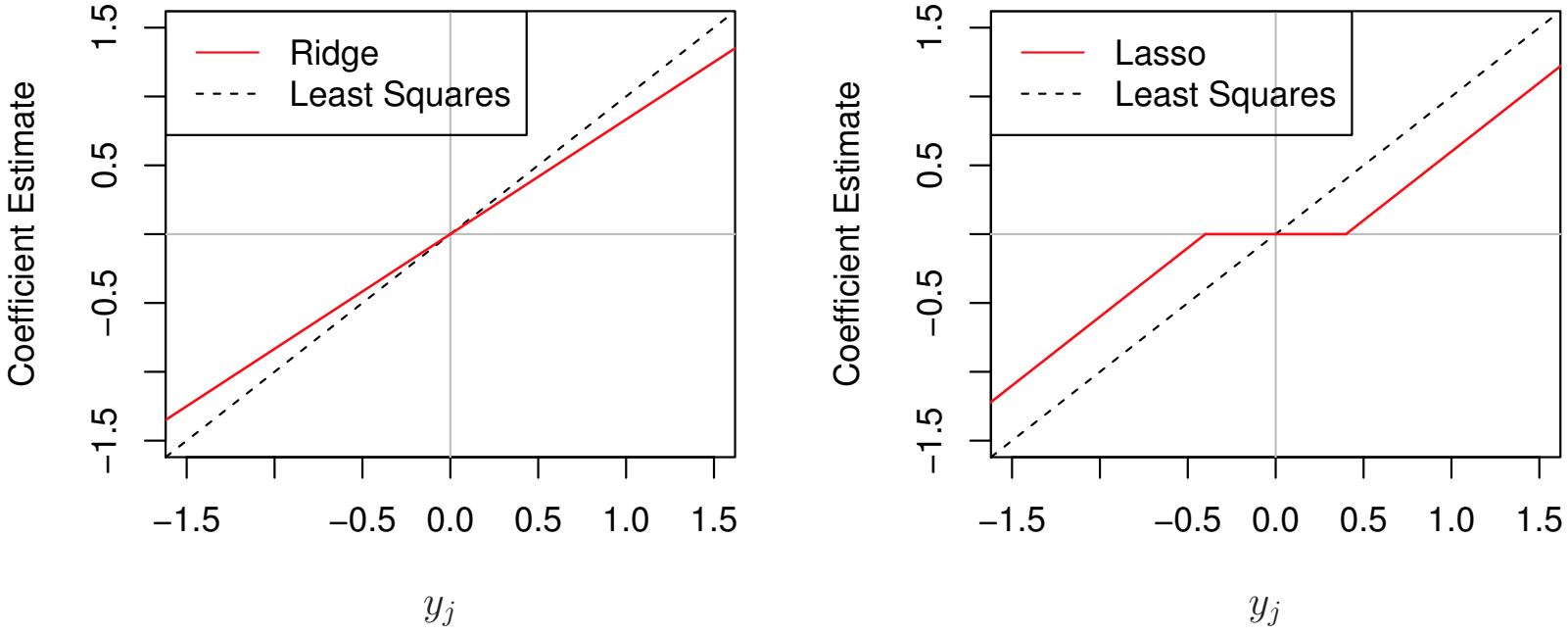
and we can minimize the terms involving each β_j individually:

$$(y_j - \beta_j)^2 + \lambda |\beta_j| \tag{30}$$

In this scenario, it can be shown that

$$\hat{\beta}_j^{LASSO} = \begin{cases} y_j - \lambda/2, & \text{if } y_j > \lambda/2 \\ y_j + \lambda/2, & \text{if } y_j < -\lambda/2 \\ 0, & \text{if } |y_j| < \lambda/2 \end{cases} \tag{31}$$

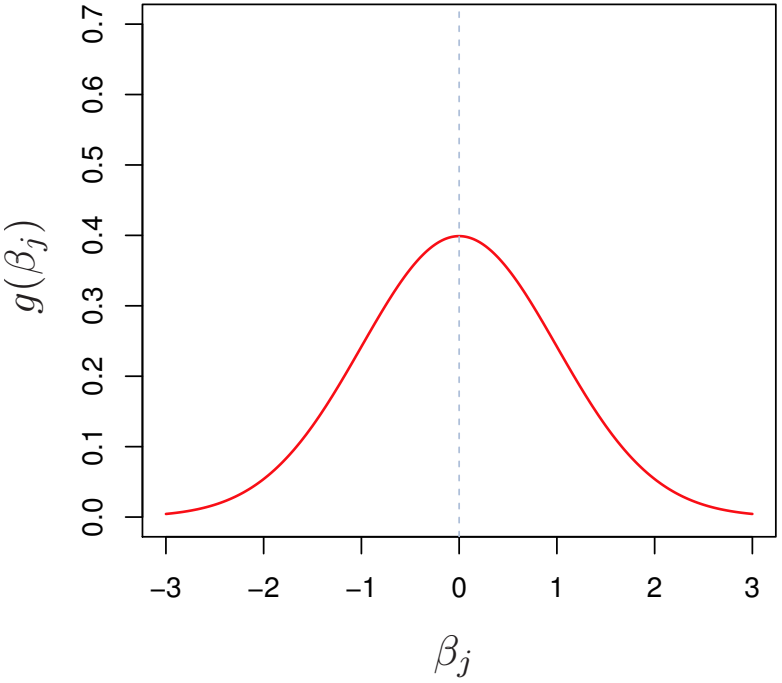
Lasso and Ridge coefficients as a function of λ

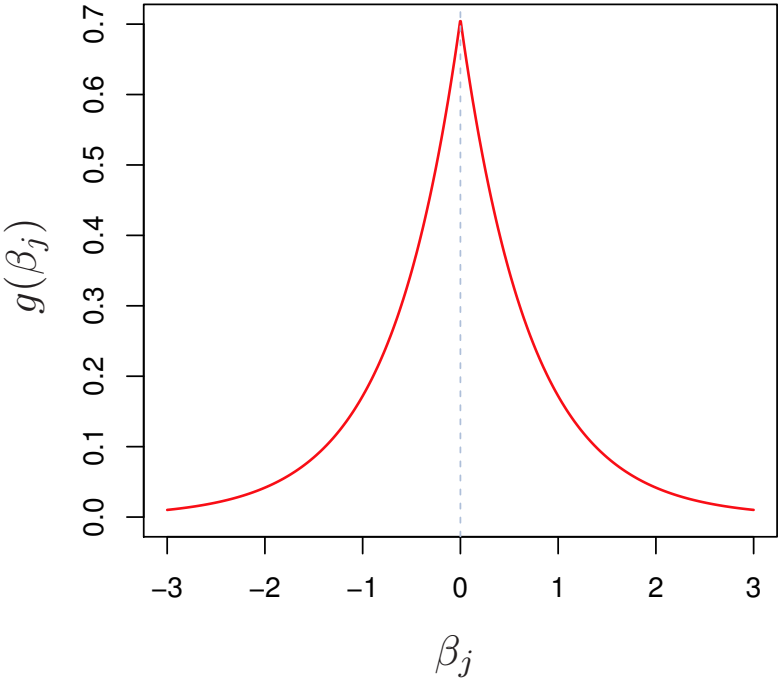


Bayesian interpretations

Ridge: $\hat{\beta}^R$ is the posterior mean, with a Normal prior on β.

Lasso: $\hat{\beta}^L$ is the posterior mode, with a Laplace prior on β.





Things to consider

- If desired, we could instead consider L_q penalties for values other than 0, 1, and 2 (e.g. $q \in (1, 2)$ or $q > 2$).
- Regularization methods such as the elastic net have been extended to generalized linear models (GLM) as well.
- L_1 and L_2 penalties are also used in contexts other than linear models (e.g. neural networks).
- As usual, we are faced with the bias-variance tradeoff when choosing our shrinkage parameters, λ_1 and λ_2.
- Other regularized methods are also available, e.g.
  - Non-negative Garotte Regression
  - Least Angle Regression
  - Best subset

Degrees of freedom

Degrees of freedom give us a measure of our model's complexity, i.e. the number of free parameters to fit on our data.

- For OLS, the degrees of freedom is equal to $p + 1$.
- In regularized regression, our parameters are estimated in a restricted manner, controlled by λ_1 and λ_2.
  - Effectively reduced the degrees of freedom in our model
- We can still compare across models using an *effective degrees of freedom*:

$$df(y, \hat{y}) = \frac{1}{\sigma^2} \sum_{i=1}^{n} Cov[y_i, \hat{y}_i | x_i] \tag{32}$$

- In the case of OLS, this can be shown to reduce to the ''standard'' degrees of freedom, i.e. $p + 1$.

References

[1] ISL. Chapters 6.

[2] ESL. Chapter 18.